Access the following web-link and explore the section entitled ‘Astronomy and space science’:
http://www.bbc.co.uk/schools then follow the links, Bitesize KS3 > Science > The environment, the Earth and the universe > Astronomy and space science > Revise (webpages available at time of publishing).

## Task

Read each of the statements in the table below.
Decide whether each is true or false and write your answer in the second column.
If the statement is false, add a correct version in the final column.

| Statement | True or false | Correct statement |
|---|---|---|
| 1. A galaxy is a collection of comets and asteroids found in outer space. | | |
| 2. There are 12 planets within the solar system. | | |
| 3. The Milky Way contains around 300 billion stars including the Sun. | | |
| 4. All objects are attracted towards each other due to the Sun’s intense heat. | | |
| 5. Planets that are furthest from the Sun are warmer, move faster and take longer to complete an orbit. | | |
| 6. Different planets take varying amounts of time to make one complete turn, so they have different day lengths. | | |
| 7. We get different seasons due to the gravitational forces between the Moon and the Earth. | | |
| 8. The Moon takes 365 days to orbit the Earth. | | |
| 9. When the Earth's shadow falls on the Moon, we get an eclipse of the Moon. | | |
| 10. Space probes orbit the Earth to collect scientific information. | | |
| 11. Artificial satellites can be used for map-making, spying, weather forecasting, navigation and | | |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| communications. | | |
| 12. The Earth is at the centre of the universe. | | |

Answers

| Statement | True or false? | Why is it false? / Corrected statement |
|---|---|---|
| 1. A galaxy is a collection of comets and asteroids found in outer space. | False | A galaxy is a group of billions of stars. |
| 2. There are 12 planets within the solar system. | False | There are eight planets within the solar system, namely Mercury, Venus, Earth, Mars, Jupiter, Saturn, Neptune and Uranus. |
| 3. The Milky Way contains around 300 billion stars including the Sun. | True | |
| 4. All objects are attracted towards each other due to the Sun's intense heat. | False | All objects are attracted towards each other by a force called gravity. |
| 5. Planets that are furthest from the Sun are warmer, move faster and take longer to complete an orbit. | False | Planets that are furthest from the Sun are colder, move more slowly and take longer to complete an orbit. |
| 6. Different planets take varying amounts of time to make one complete turn, so they have different day lengths. | True | |
| 7. We get different seasons due to the gravitational forces between the Moon and the Earth. | False | We get different seasons (winter, spring, summer and autumn) because the Earth is tilted. |
| 8. The Moon takes 365 days to orbit the Earth. | False | The Moon takes 28 days to make a complete orbit of the Earth. |
| 9. When the Earth's shadow falls on the Moon, we get an eclipse of the Moon. | True | |
| 10. Space probes orbit the Earth to collect scientific information. | False | Space probes do not orbit the Earth, but travel to other planets to collect scientific information. |
| 11. Artificial satellites can be used for map-making, spying, weather forecasting, navigation and communications. | True | |

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|---|---|---|
| 12. The Earth is at the centre of the universe. | False | The Sun is at the centre of the solar system. |

*Pluto used to be included but is now considered a minor planet.